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What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Inflation eased to 2.7%** in November, but economists cautioned against reading too much into the report because of gaps in data collection during the government shutdown. **A1**

◆ **U.S. stocks rose** after the cooler-than-expected inflation reading, with the S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow gaining 0.8%, 1.4% and 0.1%, respectively. **B1**

◆ **A merger agreement** between Trump Media and fusion company TAE Technologies marks a major foray by the first family into mainstream finance and the U.S. economy. **A1, A8**

◆ **The Bank of Japan** raised its policy rate target to its highest level in 30 years. **A9**

◆ **Hedge fund Elliott is** considering taking bookseller Barnes & Noble and U.K. book chain Waterstones public. **B1**

◆ **OpenAI aims to raise** as much as \$100 billion as it seeks to pay for ambitious growth plans in a market that has cooled on the AI boom. **B1**

◆ **The administrator** winding down what remains of Do Kwon's Terraform Labs has sued Jump Trading, alleging it unlawfully profited from and contributed to the crypto empire's collapse. **B1**

◆ **Meta Platforms is** resisting a novel IRS attack on its international tax maneuvers, the company's third Tax Court case since 2016. **A2**

◆ **Meta is developing** an image- and video-focused AI model code-named Mango alongside its next text-based large language model. **B4**

◆ **Law firm Hogan Lovells** said it would merge with Cadwalader, Wickersham & Taft in a union it described as the industry's largest ever. **B5**

World-Wide

◆ **The man suspected** of fatally shooting two Brown University students was found dead in a storage unit in New Hampshire after a six-day manhunt. **A1**

◆ **Trump answered** concerns in Asia that he could give China a pass on its increasing regional militarism with an \$11.1 billion package of arms sales for Taiwan, one of the largest ever approved for the island. **A1**

◆ **Trump directed** the federal government to reclassify cannabis as a less-dangerous drug, a seismic shift in policy that is poised to boost the legal marijuana industry. **A3**

◆ **Democratic National Committee** Chairman Ken Martin reversed course on his pledge to publicly release a detailed review of his party's mistakes in the 2024 presidential election. **A4**

◆ **European leaders failed** to agree to use frozen Russian assets to fund a loan for Ukraine but committed to providing Kyiv with a \$105 billion financial lifeline. **A9**

◆ **Trump's phased peace** plan for Gaza is struggling to move beyond its initial stage, butting up against Hamas's refusal to disarm and Israel's unwillingness to retreat from the enclave until that happens. **A10**

◆ **The John F. Kennedy** Center for the Performing Arts' board voted to add Trump's name to the institution, the White House said. **A6**

◆ **A Wisconsin state judge** was convicted of obstructing law enforcement for her role in helping a defendant in her courtroom avoid immigration agents. **A3**

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Inflation Cools, but Data Has Gaps

Shutdown affected collection in the field for the delayed November report

By CHAO DENG AND MATT GROSSMAN

Inflation eased unexpectedly in November, but economists cautioned against reading too much into the report because of gaps in data collection during the long government shutdown.

The government's closure made it impossible for Labor Department workers to collect

some of the data they normally would have to compile the report on the consumer-price index. Even before the release, economists warned that technical workarounds that the agency used to deal with the collection issues may have biased the November figure downward, causing inflation to be understated.

The Thursday report, which was released later than normal because of the shutdown, said that consumer prices rose 2.7% in November from a year earlier. That was down from 3% in September and lower than the 3.1% forecast by economists polled by The Wall

Street Journal.

Treasury yields were relatively steady following the report, but stocks climbed. The Dow gained 0.1% Thursday, while the S&P 500 added 0.8% and the Nasdaq rose 1.38%.

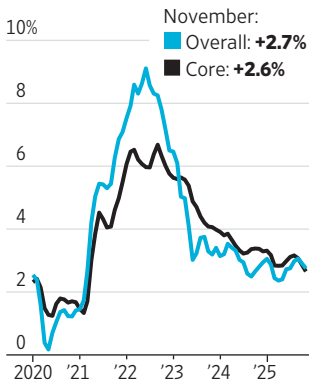
The core measure of prices, which strips out volatile food and energy costs, increased 2.6%. That was also lower than economists' expectations.

Officials weren't able to collect prices in the field during the long government shutdown that lasted until Nov. 12.

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◆ **Stocks rally as inflation abates.....** B1

Consumer-price index, change from a year earlier



Note: Data for October 2025 is unavailable. Core excludes food and energy prices. Source: Labor Department

New York City Catholics Get a New Shepherd



SEE CHANGE: Bishop Ronald Hicks of Joliet, Ill., left, was named by Pope Leo XIV to succeed Cardinal Timothy Dolan as leader of the New York Archdiocese. The two arrived at St. Patrick's Cathedral on Thursday to celebrate a Mass. A6

Suspect in Brown Campus Shooting Found Dead on Manhunt's Sixth Day

By ALYSSA LUKPAT

The man suspected of fatally shooting two Brown University students was found dead in a storage facility in New Hampshire on Thursday night after a six-day manhunt, officials said.

The alleged gunman, identified as 48-year-old Portuguese national and former Brown student Claudio Neves Valente, fatally shot himself

in a storage unit, authorities said Thursday night.

They believe he opened fire in a classroom at the Providence, R.I., campus of Brown on Saturday night, then shot Massachusetts Institute of Technology professor Nuno F.G. Loureiro, a physicist and fusion scientist, in his apartment near Boston on Monday night.

Authorities acting on a search warrant found Neves

Valente dead with firearms next to him in Salem, N.H., about 65 miles north of Providence, said Ted Docks, special agent in charge of the Federal Bureau of Investigation in Boston.

Officials said they didn't yet know why the shooter targeted Brown and believe he acted alone. They said Loureiro and Neves Valente attended the same academic program in Portugal from

1995 to 2000.

Neves Valente had enrolled in a physics graduate program from 2000 to 2001 at Brown before taking a leave of absence, then formally withdrawing, Brown President Christina Paxson said. He was only enrolled in physics classes, the majority of which have been held in the engineering building where the shooting occurred, Paxson said.

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Europe Is Flooded With Cheap Chinese Goods

Trump's tariffs redirect flow away from the U.S.; a 'new Silk Road'

By CHELSEY DULANEY AND REBECCA FENG

LONDON—President Trump's crackdown on Chinese imports in the U.S. has redirected a tsunami of cheap stuff into Europe. Some of it is pooled in Xue Er's backyard.

A stay-at-home mom in her 40s who moved from Shanghai to the U.K. in 2021, Xue recently built a 320-square-foot shed to store clothes, bags and small furniture from Chinese merchants, many of whom are eager to broaden beyond the American market. When orders come in she packs and ships the products, cutting the turnaround time. In a good month she earns £3,000 to £5,000.

Her family warehouse is a crucial part of a shadow lo-

gistic network that has powered China's trade surplus past \$1 trillion for the first time this year. Upstart cargo airlines are forging what they call a modern silk road, connecting factory hubs in China to population centers across Europe, where Chinese immigrants get paid to store goods in spare rooms.

The redirection of China's export machine is one of the most dramatic examples of how President Trump's trade war has rewired global commerce. China is outfoxing Trump's efforts to isolate Beijing, with shipments to Europe and Southeast Asia more than offsetting the nearly 20% contraction to the U.S.

The European Union has this year topped the U.S. as the largest market for China's \$100 billion cheap

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INSIDE



JASON GAY

Global soccer fans learn the expensive realities of buying tickets in the U.S. A14



MANSION

L.A.'s richest man died broke. Now his widow is fighting to keep their lavish homes. M1

The Latest Travel Scourge: People Touched by 'Jetway Jesus'

* * *

Fliers get wheeled on the plane and walk off; 'That's some good healing right there!'

By NATASHA DANGOOR

When Carlos Gomez's recent flight from Guadalajara was delayed, he asked a gate attendant why. It wasn't weather or crew shortages. There were 25 wheelchair passengers holding up boarding.

There were no such delays when Gomez's flight landed. Most of the same passengers stood up without assistance and bounded off toward the baggage claim.

Social media has credited a divine intervention for this

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Trump Company Ventures Into AI Power

Media business backed by president's family to merge with nuclear-fusion firm

First there was Truth Social. Then a streaming platform. A suite of financial products came later, as did a multibillion-dollar deal to stockpile cryptocurrency.

By David Uberti, Jennifer Hiller and Scott Patterson

Now, a merger with a fusion-energy company aims to capitalize on the latest sizzling—and speculative—market: the artificial-intelligence boom's insatiable appetite for power. Welcome to the shotgun strategy of Trump Media & Technology Group.

"The primary value of Trump Media is that Trump is the president," said Peter Schiff, a longtime financial analyst and chief economist of Euro Pacific Asset Management. "It's a company in search of a business."

A merger agreement on Thursday with TAE Technologies valued at \$6 billion marks the first family's biggest foray yet into mainstream finance and the U.S. economy since President Trump returned to the White House. While the Trump Organization continues to land new real-estate projects, and the president's sons have launched an array of new initiatives across cryptocurrency and more, few rival Thursday's deal in scale or prominence.

The tie-up is a big bet on a commercially unproven technology that has the U.S. government at its back. As AI's power needs have become a pressing economic issue, the Trump administration has unveiled a number of programs aimed at boosting technologies like fusion to meet the surging demand.

The new venture also represents the latest twist for the media company launched after Trump's ban from Twitter in 2021, just as much of Wall Street shunned the out-of-office leader following the Jan. 6 riots.

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◆ **Fusion remains energy's elusive holy grail.....** A8

◆ **Scan code to see how the family empire is set up... A8**

U.S. Lets Taiwan Buy \$11.1 Billion In Arms

By JAMES T. AREDDY

President Trump this week answered growing concerns in Asia that he could give China a pass on its increasing regional militarism with one of the largest-ever U.S. arms sales to Taiwan.

The \$11.1 billion package, featuring Himars and howitzer weapons designed to bolster Taiwan's ability to slow any Chinese attack on the island, drew applause in Washington, where support for Taiwan runs strong, and tempered some worries about his stance.

The chairman of a House Committee on China, John Moolenaar (R., Mich.), called the weapons deal "an outstanding move."

But the sale was announced just before the bilateral China committee issued a report on Thursday that warned that Beijing is exploiting doubts about U.S. support for Taiwan by increasing military provoca-

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